

Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC

Austin-Healey

The Goldsmith's 3000 Mk 1



OCTOBER 2012
NEW MEMBER - ALAN MCCARTHY
A VERY WET START
MEMBERS' DILEMMAS
AUSTIN-HEALEYS IN POLAND

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AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

Read all about the Goldsmith's 3000 Mk 1, starting on page 10.

Flat Chat

OCTOBER 2012

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY CLUB (NSW) INC

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DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

2012

OCTOBER

- 10-Monthly Meeting
- 10-GEAR Wakefield Park
- 14-Lunch at Patonga
- 17-Committee Meeting
- 20/26-Charlie's Run

NOVEMBER

- 4-AHOC Concours
- 10-Open Garden Day
- 14-Annual General Meeting
- 21-Committee Meeting

- 24-26-Tasman Revival at Eastern Creek
- 25-Annual Inspection Day

DECEMBER

- 1-AHOC Christmas Party
 - 12-Monthly Meeting
 - 19-Committee Meeting
- #### JANUARY 2013
- 9-Monthly Meeting
 - 16-Committee Meeting
 - 20-Presentation Breakfast

If you have any questions about the above events please contact our club secretary Gordon Lynas (02) 9944 4789

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

JOHN KENT (02) 9498 8193

Our Committee has undertaken its review of the Club's constitution which includes amendments to meet the requirements of the Office of Fair Trading and our own into the future. These amendments will be put to the Club membership at an Extraordinary Meeting, if the timing allows will be held in conjunction with our Annual General Meeting in November. This will be a very important meeting and will provide members the opportunity to make input. The revisions to the constitution have taken into account the numerous comments made to Committee members prior to our review. If accepted by the members, the amended constitution has then to go through an approval process by the Office of Fair Trading so it will be well into 2013 before it comes into force.

In the next few months we have a number of events, which I am hoping will attract good attendance.

The Concours de Elegance and Display Day at Memorial Park, The Entrance on Sunday 4th November provides members an opportunity to polish their cars and show them off. It's a time to showcase our cars to the broader community and increase awareness of what a beautiful car the Austin-Healey is in this world off mass produced characterless vehicles. Further details of this event are included in this issue of Flat Chat.

Our Christmas Party on Saturday 1st December is at the Epping Club. If you are attending it would help our Treasurer immeasurably if you could pay before the event so that Jim doesn't have to chase up folks on the night, making for a less than enjoyable night for him.

The Rally website is up and running through our Club website and we already have a number of bookings including one couple from overseas. Please get in early so that we can start to establish the numbers required to make it a great rally.



HOLIDAY FUN

Austin-Healey Owners Club of New South Wales Christmas Party

This year we are celebrating the start of the festive season with our Christmas party at the Epping Club, 45 Rawson Street, Epping. It will be held on Saturday, 1st December from 7pm to midnight.

I am pleased to say that we have secured the Grand Salon which offers a warm, intimate and friendly atmosphere. Up to 80 guests can enjoy a banquet dinner, preceded by pre-dinner drinks and canapés on the Salon's private lobby area.

The cost per ticket will be \$60 per head which will ensure you a lovely dinner and a chance to dance the night away and have a wonderful evening with your Austin-Healey friends.

Tickets are now available.

Anne Read
(02) 4841 0095
anne.monaro@bigpond.com



CLUB COMMITTEE

2012

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Librarian
Stuart McColl

CMC Delegate
Ray Roberts

Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Sue Darlington

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

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those of the Editor or the AHOC (NSW) (Inc).



Greetings and welcome to the October issue of Flat Chat. Blind Freddy would see that we are coming to the end of the year and as happens there are more than enough events to keep us all occupied. As you will see in this issue there are notices for our Concours de Elegance on Sunday 4th November, the Annual General Meeting on 14th November, the Club's Christmas Party scheduled for Saturday, 1st December and lastly the 2013 National Rally. Please look for them throughout this issue.

This month's feature car is the Mk1 3000 of Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith and it's probably a car that you haven't seen all that much of, unless you are a follower of Historic Motor Sport. Colin bought his car for one purpose and that's to enjoy motor racing and while it's occasionally used on the road, you are better off seeing it at the various circuits along the Eastern Seaboard.

In case you were concerned that they won't be included, all the normal Committee reports are within this issue of Flat Chat as well as I trust a few other bits and pieces half worth reading. Firstly thanks to Don Hardie and Allan Whitehouse for sending in a few words of what they have been up to. I can well sympathise with Don as I remember very clearly my first couple of years of Austin-Healey ownership were peppered with broken rear wheel studs. In fact I lost a rear wheel on my first day of ownership and there was one time when a rear axle clearly came into view while turning on to Allison Road at Randwick.

Yes we have a new member this month. Honestly to be pedantic, Alan McCarthy is not a new member, but is returning to the Club after being a member during the 1970s. You can meet Alan on P8.

A couple of months back the whole issue of Flat Chat was dedicated to Australia delivered cars with the feature car being Robert and Toni Harrison's BJ8. Well, Rob and Toni also have a BN1 and while it was acquired relatively recently it was also Rob's first Austin-Healey and his first car many years back. Thanks to well known restorer (and 3000 Mk1 owner) Terry Cornelius of Corowa, Rob can put together a little bit extra of his car's history. You can read about this starting on page 14.

Overseas Austin-Healeys? They are in many places that you probably wouldn't think about. Recently there was the first gathering ever of Austin-Healeys in Poland. Thanks to Polish enthusiast Tadek Malkiewicz we can read all about it on page 16.

Bonneville

Last month I made mention of a member of our Club who was set-

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ting off to Bonneville with his four-cylinder Austin-Healey with the intention of setting a 200 mph + record. It was Steve Pike, the proprietor of Marsh Classic Restoration in conjunction with his wife Helen.

In anyone's language preparing a car in Australia with a view of running it on the other side of the world is no mean feat. Plus running at Bonneville is just not a matter of arriving, turning up the wick and setting the speed. No you have to go through a staged process and be certified for a set speed before you aim at a higher speed. In Steve's case he made a total of five runs and never got out of 3rd gear. However while running at just over 158mph the cylinder head cried enough and part of it broke away. That was the end of Steve's 2012 effort and hopefully you can read all about it in next month's issue of Flat Chat.

I hope you enjoy this issue of Flat Chat.

Austin Healey
Owners Club NSW
 Established 1969

Have you had a look at the Club's website lately? Thanks to Alan Mitchell it has been complexly revised and includes new pages on the 2013 National Rally, benefits for members and digital copies of magazines from other Austin-Healey clubs around the world.

WWW.AUSTINHEALEYNSW.COM.AU

■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE:

12 SEPTEMBER 2012

MEETING COMMENCED: 8.05 PM

Apologies: Gordon Lynas, Diana and Stuart McColl, Barry and Karyn Birch, and Patrick Quinn.

New Members/Visitors: Greg and Dianne Strange

■ PRESIDENT

- Committee spent time reviewing the Club's constitution led by Gordon Lynas. The outcome to be amended for review by the Committee then to be tabled to all members at a General or Special Meeting for consideration and possible approval (subject to acceptance criteria).
- Number of social events: Christmas Party at the Epping Club. National Rally information is on the website to make bookings – don't forget that this is the Canberra Centenary with lots of events on – so BOOK EARLY. Sunday visit to Thirlmere Train Museum.
- Minutes of the General Meeting need to be proposed & seconded: July General Meeting minutes proposed by John Sherman and seconded by Neville Stirton – July minutes as tabled in the Flat chat magazine have now been accepted.
- 2013 National Rally – planning for the National Rally is progressing very well, outstanding invites have been sent to overseas interested parties and additional sponsorship seeking is under way.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

- Tickets for the National Rally raffle still coming back slowly.
- Tassie trip 2013 vacancies for October 2013 still available

■ SECRETARY

Mail received:

- CAMS – Voting Papers for 2013 NSW State Council elections – Return before 24 October.
- CAMS Calendar update has been put onto AHOC website.

Mail Sent:

- CAMS Nil Claims Declaration returned to OAMPS for insurance renewal.

Events & Activities:

- Morris 1000 Canberra Celebration and Tour 19-22 April 2013.
- Highlands Motorfest & Chevalier Fete at Chevalier college Bowral Sunday 28 October 2012 Motorfest entrants \$10/vehicle \$5.bike gates open 7:00am

Magazines received:

- Hundreds & Thousands (AHOC Vic) September
- Healey Torque (AHOC Qld) September
- Healeys West September
- Healey Howl (AHOC SA) Spring 2012
- Healeys return to Bonneville Newsletter No 22
- CAMS Speed Read.

■ TREASURER

- Charlie's run payments are now due if you have not already paid – please contact the Treasurer to make suitable arrangements.

Members Funds as at 10 June 2012:

Westpac Cash Management Account	\$30,261
Westpac Business Cash Reserve Account	\$10,284
Westpac Term Deposits balance	\$57,527
Sub total	\$97,873
Outstanding deposits for Charlie's Run	\$14,600
Christmas Party	\$427
Club Net Funds	\$82,853

National Rally payment \$1,341 and \$6,500 deposits for Eagle Hawk, bags and logo. Entertainment deposit paid in August, \$3,800 proceeds from Rally Raffle; looking to break even costs with no club subsidy, but budget allows for contingency of small deficit. Break even numbers for the National Rally are 174 attendees.

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY

- Sunday 14 October 2012 Claytons Run to Patonga
- Saturday 20 - Friday 26 October Charlie's Run – see magazine for details
- Saturday 1 December Christmas Party – Epping Club booked for sit down dinner
- National Rally Easter 2013
- Possible event weekend to Hill End 2013?

■ EDITOR • Nil report.

■ COMPETITION SECRETARY • Nil report.

■ HISTORIAN

- Steve Pike at Bonneville achieved best run of 158mph but was not able to complete due to engine trouble – don't forget to check out the Bonneville Newsletters on the website
- 200mph club membership for Donald Healey – invited and accepted.
- DMH was the first Englishman to win at Monte Carlo Rally
- AH4000 example in Melbourne
- Datsun bought 2 Healey 3000s that went to Japan - were used as development projects for and guide for the development of the Datsun 240Z
- Check out the International Healey mailing list – Google it
- Austin-Healeys at 2012 Olympics – check out the cars

■ REGALIA/PUBLIC RELATIONS

- Lots of badges available
- AHOC rear window sticker available – if you do not have one contact the Secretary/Regalia Officer to arrange for one.
- Richard gave a run down on his trip to USA and in particular his attendance at Pebble Beach – principal marque this year was the Shelby Cobra and the Art Deco styling vehicles of the 20s and 30s. The Shelby in remembrance of the passing of Carroll Shelby, the 50th Anniversary of the AC Cobra
- Did you know that at the 4th Pebble Beach presentation an Austin-Healey 100 won Best in Show.

■ LIBRARIAN • Nil report.

■ CLUB REGO • Nil Report

■ MEMBERSHIP

- 35 members attended tonight's Club meeting
- 2013 membership will be by invoice sent to all members

■ CMC

- CMC Menangle Park Run and Studley Park (this was used for code breaking during the war)
- 1st Tuesday of November (6/11/2012) CMC Run to Rouse Hill Farm followed by lunch at Ettamogah Pub, Rouse Hill

■ GENERAL BUSINESS

- AHOC 2012 Goodwood represented by Margaret Johnston's grandson invited to the J40 pedal car event – William Johnston won the J40 Pedal Car event

■ FOR SALE/WANTED

- Factory Hardtop for Mk 1/2 Austin-Healey – Neville Stirton
- Wanted Lucas flasher unit John Kent

■ RAFFLE

- Proceeds \$56.70. Patricia Bancroft won the digital photo frame.

Meeting concluded at 9.22pm.



I would like to thank those members who have given me some items to raffle in the past few months, as it's appreciated very much indeed. An afterthought on my behalf is the donation from Pamela and Doug Ross towards our coming National Rally in Canberra 2013. Apparently they won a prize on their recent trip to America at one of the meets attended and have provided it to Jim Phillips our Treasurer. Many thanks from all of us.

I'm pleased to say the booking for this year's Christmas Party at The Epping Club on Saturday 1st December are looking quite pleasing. If you haven't booked yet please think about contacting me very soon.

Thirlmere Rail Museum! Well what can I say? Most impressed with the attendance I was, and what a lovely day. The Museum is a credit to those many volunteers who offer their valuable time. After viewing the Museum it was a ride to Buxton behind a locomotive and on return we adjourned to have lunch at the local pub.

Our next Social event is Patonga for fish n chips. You can get there via the F3 or by ferry - all details below. Please I need numbers for lunch, as Patonga on weekends is a very busy place. Judy Sherman has been kind enough to organise this event for me and will arrange bookings.

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY- 2012

OCTOBER

Sunday 14th - Patonga. Ferry from Palm Beach, lunch and back on ferry. Clayton's Run parking (limited and unsecure) at Careel Bay Playing Fields, 873 Barrenjoey Rd, Avalon. The L90 Bus at 10am will take you to the Palm Beach wharf for the ferry to Patonga. \$15/16 return on ferry, \$10 for seniors. **Saturday/Friday 20th-26th** - Charlie's Run.

NOVEMBER

Saturday 4th - AHOC Concours de Elegance - See page 9 for details.

Saturday 10th - Caroline and Patrick Quinn are opening their garden to visitors as part of Open Gardens Australia. Entry proceeds towards research into Anorexia Nervosa. The garden is also open on Sunday 11th. **Sunday 25th** - Annual inspection day for cars on Conditional Registration at Richard Horwood's home.

DECEMBER

Saturday 1st - AHOC Christmas Party - We have the Epping Club booked for annual dinner and dance. I am waiting to take your calls or email to anne.monaro@bigpond.com

JANUARY

Sunday 20th - The date has been set for our Presentation Breakfast. Jill and Stan Goodwin have kindly offered their home once more for this event. More details to follow in December.

I would like to take this opportunity to thank everyone for your support on the social events that I have organised. Also thanks to Geoff Smith for standing in for me at Committee meetings.

I will not be standing for any position on next year's Committee, but will offer the new Social Secretary all my help for events held down south.

Our very important event next year is our National Rally. There has been many hours put in by the Rally Committee to make this the best value for money Rally. So I do hope our members will make an extra effort to support this event to be held over the Easter Weekend in Canberra. Another thing to think about, is that next year will be Canberra's centenary.

Tickets are now on sale though our web site www.austin-healeynsw.com.au and follow the instructions.

If you have any trouble, please contact me and I WILL HELP YOU.

**For information about the 2013
Australian Austin-Healey National Rally
Please see Page 24.**



**AHOC 2012
Concours de Elegance
Sunday 4th November
See Page 9 for details.**



Profile: Alan McCarthy

Name: Alan McCarthy

Occupation: Retired Aircraft Engineer

Where Do You Live? Sydney

What Model Austin-Healey? 1955 100 BN1

After a break of a few months it's nice to see that we have a new member. Actually Alan McCarthy is not a new member, but a returning member, having being in the AHOC during the 1970s. Of course I know that in welcoming him back, I speak for all members.

Why did you buy an Austin-Healey? It was during the 1970s that I bought the car. I looked around at what was available on the market like MGs, Triumphs and the like. I looked at a few Austin-Healeys and they really impressed me, not only for their performance, but also their good looks. I bought it from a couple in the Hills area of Sydney in reasonably good condition

Did you specifically set out to buy the model that you bought? Back in the '70s there weren't all that many to choose from and while I knew of the six-cylinder cars, I saw this one for sale and decided that it was exactly what I was looking for.

What was it like when you bought it?

As mentioned it was in reasonably good condition and back then I wasn't married and used the 100 for my everyday car. Then it blew a head gasket and that sort of changed things. It was blue when I bought it, but it wasn't hard to tell that it was originally a green car.

How have you been using the car? It was in 1977 when I put it on blocks in Sydney. I did start a restoration and partially stripped the car and completely rebuilt the engine which included careful balancing. However the engine wasn't put back together. Then my job as an aircraft engineer took me to Indonesia and eventually to Singapore, Greece and back to Indonesia again. During all the time I was away, the car was stored on blocks in Sydney.

In the interim I managed to get a job back in Australia, but in Cairns, Queensland. So I took the car with me with the best of intentions to rebuild it. Of course there wasn't much done to it, but I did discover Sunbeams and bought an Alpine and a Tiger which I still have.

When I retired we came back to Sydney along with the two Sunbeams. The 100 came too, but that was a special six day trip to Cairns, securing the car to the trailer and then driving back. By that stage it was a rolling chassis with the front and rear suspension still installed. The engine came back sitting where the passenger seat is normally.



Alan's car back in the 70s.



Back in Sydney



Stripped to the bones.

Since back in Sydney the car has been stripped completely. I can see that there has been some less than perfect accident repairs to the left front. There is not that much rust that I can see, but things like the inner and outer sills need to be replaced as will the front cross member. In the body, the bottoms of the doors will need replacing as will the rear doglegs. Just yesterday I removed the floors to check what the chassis rails are like.

I am really amazed at the availability of spares that weren't around when I first started stripping the car. It's wonderful that places like Kilmartins and AH Spares can supply almost everything needed.

As to colour I am not too sure. It was originally British Racing Green, but the Tiger is green and I don't want two green cars. So it might be done in dark blue.

AHOC Concours d'Elegance and Display Day

Memorial Park, The Entrance • Sunday 4th November 2012

Our 2012 Concours d'Elegance and display day will be held on Sunday, 4th November commencing at 10.00 am and finishing at 3.00 pm. Come along to show your car, even if you do not intend to have it judged. Memorial Park is located on The Entrance Road, The Entrance.

The following awards and classes will be judged.

CONCOURS MASTER CLASS

Vehicles in this class should be prepared to the highest possible standards of condition and originality. Judging will be via detailed judging sheets based on the USA model. Entry is open to any Austin Healey model.

BEST RECENT REBUILD

This class is designed for vehicles which have been rebuilt in the recent past, but not prepared in, terms of originality, to Master Class standards. There will be one trophy awarded to the best car across all model groups.

ROAD CAR CLASS

This class offers vehicles that are used regularly the opportunity to receive recognition. There will be up to four trophies

awarded for the following model groups.

100, 100/6, 3000 (BT and BN series) and 3000 (BJ series).

Cars will be judged using a short set of criteria with the emphasis on condition and presentation.

Vehicles must have been driven a minimum of 500 miles in the last year. (We will rely on owners' honesty this year in regards to this criteria). Miles this year will be recorded for next year's event.

MISCELLANEOUS (FACTORY) HEALEY

This category is specifically for factory prepared specials, Works race or rally cars and DHMC built vehicles. Judging will be based on a similar format to the Road Class Cars. One trophy will be awarded to the best vehicle in this class across all vehicles.

MODIFIED HEALEY

Caters for vehicles which have been modified for competition or as Works replica vehicles. Judging will be on a similar basis to the Road Car Class with "period" modifications and retention of original engines and gear boxes preferred. One trophy will be awarded to the best vehicle in this class across all vehicles.

BEST DISPLAY

If the above judging classes do not appeal to you why not bring your car and set up a special display using whatever theme you can imagine (it could be a comprehensive record of the car's rebuild shown pictorially). You are only limited by your imagination. The judges will award a prize for the best display.

FURTHEST TRAVELLED

The vehicle driven the furthest distance from its normal place of residence under its own power (not on a trailer/truck). So all our out of town members add some fuel and join us at The Entrance

PEOPLE'S CHOICE

This will be awarded to the vehicle which receives the most number of votes. To encourage more people to vote, there will be a number of prizes drawn for those club members who put their entries in.

The winners will be announced on the day, with the presentations made at our Annual Presentation Breakfast in 2013. The Concours Sub-Committee reserves the right to review entries and suggest alternative classes for any vehicle. They also reserve the right to not award trophies due to insufficient entries or vehicle standards

If you have any questions or need to seek clarification on any point please call John Kent on 0419 497 033.

We are also looking for help with the judging on the day so if you would like to be involved please contact John Kent.





Story by Patrick Quinn

Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith's 3000 Mk 1

If you are in the slightest bit interested in motor racing you would know that there are a handful of Austin-Healeys being actively campaigned in Australian Historic Motor Sport. In New South Wales there are two 3000s being punted around the circuits.

Last month we had a close look at Brian Duffy's Sebring 3000 and you would have read that Brian also enjoys his 3000 Mk1 on tracks up and down the Eastern Seaboard. The other car is the dark blue BT7 Mk 1 of Colin Goldsmith.

Of course most members would be well aware that Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith have been members of the Club since the mid 1990s when they bought a BN2. We recently caught up with Colin at Wakefield Park in between moments of excitement out on the track.

I am always interested why members have bought an Austin-Healey in the first place, so that was my first question. In response Colin said. "It goes back to when I was a child and a very good friend of my fathers by the name of Stuart Todhunter bought a 100. Stuart was a solicitor in Parramatta and was active in motor racing after WW2. I can still remember seeing that car for the first time when we went to Silverdale Hillclimb in it - Stuart Todhunter, my father and myself. That morning I was told to stand outside the front of our house and wait for Mr Todhunter. Prior to that the only thing I knew about an Austin was the little A30, so that's what I was waiting for. When this bloke

turned up in the ice blue 100, I thought it was the most beautiful car I had ever seen in my life. It was a John Crouch car and Stuart used to run it in hillclimbs. I think that the car is still in New South Wales." (Yes it belongs to a club member. PQ)

"Not long after, my father bought a Bug Eye Sprite, which I eventually took over from him and drove for many, many years. Then I got sensible when marriage, mortgage and kids came along and that was sold and I bought a VW Golf and several other things. Later on I was looking for something a little different and the idea of getting a Harley-Davidson bike came to me. Then I was out with my daughter at a horse gymkhana at Anna Bay near Port Stephens and we were camping. It was pouring and the rain was coming down. Along the road came about fifty bikes and everyone was looking absolutely miserable. I remember thinking that I couldn't imagine Delwyn sitting on the back of a bike in the rain. So that put paid to that."

Morgan

"I then turned towards a Morgan." Colin added. "Not long after I started thinking of the Austin-Healey that I rode in years beforehand. I looked in the paper and soon after heard of John Dowsett. Anyway my first Austin-Healey was a BN2 that we bought in 1996. It was one of those cars that came in boxes and with the help of John it was all put together. It was a lovely car that we really enjoyed. It was a really nice car to drive as it han-



dled so well. I ran a couple of supersprints in it and I found them to be a real lot of fun. All that led me to think of going a little bit further as far as racing goes. So I spoke seriously to John about it and came to the conclusion that the BN2 wasn't the way to go."

"Apart from knowing that the BN2 was an Australian delivered car in Melbourne during 1956, I didn't know its history. It required a full restoration from the chassis up. It was restored with the normal 'M' specs for a little more power and was sold in 2005 to help fund the 3000, along with the Bug Eye Sprite that I was racing. A bloke in Sweden bought it through Ian Cummins Motors, however before it left the country it was sent to Marsh Classic for a full restoration."

The 3000

"The 3000 was ex US and was brought in by Steve Pike." Colin added. "It was sold new in Pennsylvania in 1959. John arranged the car to be bought from Steve and like the BN2 it was also a basket case, but even worse."

"The chassis looked as it had been a cut and shut at one stage and frankly it was a real mess. We had to cut the front of the



THE GOLDSMITH'S 3000 MK I



chassis off and splice a brand new section on, courtesy of Kilmartins. Not an easy task and looking back if I had to do it again I would have Kilmartins build me a new chassis. All up it took 18 months to build the car. It has a fully worked engine and as it's confined to the rules of Historic Motor Sport there isn't a lot that can be done past that. It has twin 2in SUs, but the internals of the engine has such things as a steel crankshaft, rods and all the good bits. It has a Subaru limited slip diff in the back which fits straight in to the Austin banjo."

"Of course it's got all those bits that supposedly make it go a little faster. Apart from that it's a relatively standard car that I do drive on the road, but not all that often. I drive it to John's workshop when something has to be done and I drove it to the All British Day at Parramatta. It's quite a good car to drive on the road, but does need a few changes to the setup to make it a comfortable car to drive on the road. However I'm not prepared to make those changes just for a one day drive in the country."

Building

I was interested as to the role Colin takes with his 3000 such as was it a matter of having John do everything or was it more hands on.

"With the BN2, John did everything," Colin responded. "With the 3000 I was the gopher with me going to John's workshop for at least four days a week or even more. I did all the paint preparation, suspension fitting, wiring installation etc. John did the painting while Alan Coles did quite a bit of the body work. I am



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very happy I did it that way as I know where every nut and bolt goes. It also saved me a huge amount of money."

"While I'm usually at the back of the grid I enjoy it, as well as really enjoy having a good looking car that people come up to me and comment about it. The car also sounds good, it handles well and I can say that I am very happy with it and I'm very proud of it. Sometimes I just enjoy sitting in it. It's lots and lots of fun."

"As to tomorrow I would like to think I would keep racing the car into the future. We used to go on a lot of Charlie's Runs in the BN2 and really enjoyed them. We have kept on doing that in our modern car and I think that will continue while the 3000 is purely for racing. I can't really see myself returning the 3000 back into a road car. Eventually I think it will be sold as is, but things change and who knows what the future will bring."

"After some time at sorting out problems with the brakes, tyres and ignition the car is now running very well indeed and in fact its only limiting factor is the driver. However both Delwyn and I like to attend as many Club events as we can. We like the mid-week runs and as mentioned there's the Charlie's Runs like the one in a few weeks. I haven't been to many monthly meetings of late as I am doing a course at Miller Tech in race car technology that's on Tuesday and Wednesday nights. We enjoy the Club, we enjoy the friendship and being with other members."

Many thanks to Steve Oom for the racing photos.





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A Very Wet Start

by Terry Cornelius

It was a simple enough plan. Leave home Saturday morning, travel the seven hour trip up the Hume to Sydney, make my way to Wally Gates' home at Mount Colah, load up the Austin-Healey, stay overnight and get an early start next morning for a reasonable time of arrival back at Corowa.

I was collecting a very rough 100 that I had bought from Wally about two years (yes, two years!) beforehand. Being no stranger to Wally and his home, having purchased the Sabrina Austin from him and having stayed with him from time to time as well, I had no navigation problems. Plan A was well under way as Wally and I pushed the old 100 onto my trailer. Being, to a large degree, dismantled, quite some time was then spent loading parts into the XJ6 tow car and tying panels and things in place on the Austin-Healey. Eventually I had a rough but fairly orderly load and would be ready for my 5am start next morning.

Wally's place on Ku-ring-gai Chase Road had a very large backyard opening onto a reserve area. This was used by him and neighbours for rear access to an adjoining street, so my car-trailer combination was parked strategically behind the house ready for an uninterrupted run to and through the back gate, turn left, up the unmade hill, onto that adjoining street and the first leg of the long journey home.

Some time through the night however, it began to rain heavily. By the time 5am came around and I'd said my good-byes to Wal, the back yard had become quite waterlogged and after some wheel-spinning forward movement I got that 'sinking' (pun intended) feeling and I knew that without assistance I wouldn't even get as far as the back gate.

NRMA seemed like the best option so I phoned them. By the time their advance scout arrived and decided that his Toyota ute wasn't the vehicle for the job, my hopes of an early start were waning. At least Mr NRMA was able to use his radio and a tow truck was soon dispatched. The rain continued.

Tow Truck

The tow truck duly arrived and managed to pull the Jaguar and trailer as far as just short of Wally's back gate before it became bogged as well. So, what next?

Another NRMA tow truck, a heavy one of course, so the



A young Rob Harrison and his first 100.

radio call went out again. Still the rain tumbled down.

By the time the heavy metal arrived, the back gate area was awash. At this stage, a direct tow from in front of the bogged truck was out of the question, so the "heavy towie" stood off and rigged a pulley onto a handy tree and with the cable at right-angles, set the truck's winch in motion. Perhaps the trailer could have been disconnected to lighten the load, but that would only have presented another problem. So as the entourage inched forward and out the back gate, the continuing rain was turning that low area into an ever-deepening creek. Of course by now, the time also was being swallowed up and some post-breakfast neighbours were gathering, umbrellas aloft to witness proceedings.

After some time, #1 tow truck reached the tree followed by the inevitable re-arrangement of the cable, so an attempt was then made to drive #2 truck forward. Meantime, barely noticed, another two heavy trucks had arrived and were standing by on the road at the top of the hill. Lucky, because one of those trucks was indeed to be needed before the rescue operation would be completed.

The rain continued to bucket down, while the crowd of



The now Harrison 100 on its way back to Sydney.



The Harrison 100 in readiness for paint.

onlookers, some with cameras, continued to swell. The 'creek' did likewise, threatening to overlap the sills of the XJ6 as it inched forward. By now the team of NRMA attendants were working like the proverbial well-oiled machine and the progress was relentless until finally, amid cheers from the spectators, we were clear of the ever-worsening conditions and on the asphalt.

So much for the 5am start, as by the time I ultimately moved away via my own power, the clock had long struck twelve bells. Then, as if I wasn't late enough already, somewhere along the way, before I had gotten clear of the land of traffic lights, I spent another unproductive, but welcome half-hour when I was waved down by someone who was curious to know what an Austin-Healey was doing on a trailer

in his neck of the woods.

The rest of the trip was uneventful and in spite of any plans I may have had for that Austin-Healey, fate would play its hand and ultimately, many years later (almost exactly twenty in fact) it would make its way back up the Hume from whence it came.

That fateful wet day was Sunday 23rd April, 1989, being the occasion of one of Sydney's biggest rainstorms. Who was it who pulled me over that afternoon? Why that was Don Read of course.

And why did the 100 end up returning to Sydney? Well that's because it belongs (once again) to who else but Rob Harrison.



by Tadek Malkiewicz

Polish Austin-Healey Gathering

Frequently we hear of Austin-Healey gatherings in the UK and the US. Last month we heard of a run to the most northern part of Europe, so when I heard from Polish owner Tadek Malkiewicz of the first every gathering of Austin-Healeys in Poland I asked him to put a few words together.

Tadek has a BN2 and is a telecommunications consultant in Cracow, southern Poland with his wife Elizabeth and five children – Kate, Jan, Alexandra and twins Julie and Antonine. I should say that Tadek's command of English is way better than my Polish.

Tadek bought his 1956 BN2 in the US, where the car had suffered from typical US body jobs that in later years proved to be a horror to more careful restorers. Plastic filler, terrible welding, more plastic, etc, etc. Tadek says that since in his hands, the car was restored in every possible detail he could attend to and like many BN2s was also converted to Le Mans specs.

While Tadek undertook the majority of the work himself he is quick to acknowledge the support of numerous people. One in particular was the Austin-Healey Club of America's 100 Registrar, Rich Chrysler. Tadek said that "with whom I exchanged hundreds of emails detailing the car. His help across the ocean was truly, truly invaluable, his patience (with small details like the direction of the key in the boot lock when closed) stunning." Sadly Rich recently died after a long illness.

As to the Austin-Healeys in Poland, Tadek says that they "were present in Poland even during the Communist regime - I recently learned that they were used by some high Communist party members (as other cars, like Volvo 1800, Porsches and others). However, I do not believe that many survived from that time; also, I do not believe that there were more than couple (less than ten?). (I know of one exported to Sweden in 1985."

"The new classic car fever (that is yet to reach a higher

temperature) is slowly growing in Poland since 1990. Austin-Healeys play a small role in this market - three years ago there were ten Big Healeys registered in Poland, the number probably doubled by now."

Tadek finished up saying that "2012 was the 1st occasion to meet during a Classic Motor show in Cracow, southern Poland. Two of the cars participated in a 750km 1st Classic Rally of Poland. As you can see there are a lot of 'Firsts' there. We plan to meet again next year, hopefully with more cars!"



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The Austin-Healey Tricycle

*By Don and Margo Hardie
(Not shaken or stirred!)*

Late June the Austin-Healey threw the left rear wheel at 70 MPH while on the F3. Thankfully the exhaust took the weight of that corner and saved the bottom of the rear shroud from damage, but the brake backing plate and the lining on the bottom brake shoe also hit the road surface. What happened was that despite always using Loctite the nuts holding the splined hub had come loose, the studs then stripped and consequently the wheel came off and proceeded about 300 meters along the Armco.

NRMA Classic Insurance came to the party for the repairs, except for the stripped hub and studs which caused the rest of the damage. They paid for a splined hub and knock-on, an aluminium Alfin brake drum, brake backing plate, relining the brake shoes, new muffler and tail pipe and the assistance of Geoff Smith Automotive's great repairs. The insurer also paid for Lambert Smash Repairs of Woy Woy to repair and repaint the mudguard which was also damaged. New nuts were also fitted to both sides at the same time.

The run to The All British Day in August was the first time out after all that trauma and the beast behaved its self very well there and back. Considering that this was the first accident in twenty-four years, we're hoping the next twenty-four will be plain sailing. Oops that should be Healeying.

PS New studs will be fitted to the other side very soon.



Anti-Sway Me Now!

by Allan Whitehouse

Have you ever looked underneath the front of your Austin-Healey and noticed a few lumps of what looks like bits of red plastic? Well I did recently and there were ... lots of them.

It took me a few seconds to realise that these were in fact bits of anti-sway bar link bushes which had hardened and broken off. Further inspection revealed that several of these bushes were badly perished and in need of immediate replacement.

My first thought was to look up the Nolathane website, where selecting Austin-Healey 3000 only gave me the control arm and spring eye bushings, but no sway bar link info. Next I downloaded their PDF catalogue which showed Austin-Healey applications listed on page 33. Unfortunately the catalogue only went as far as page 30. But wait, they listed retailers near me such as Autobarn, Repco and Auto-pro. I drove around to all of these outlets, but none could find a part number for the bush I needed, and the sales people did not have the time or desire to search through their stocks to try and match the sample I took along.

Pausing for thought, I remembered that a company synonymous with suspension parts was K-Mac as I knew they made springs, anti-sway bars and all sorts of other goodies. A quick trip over to their factory in Rockdale with a bush in the hand (or is that a bird in the bush?), I purchased 8 of the ones I wanted for the princely sum of \$22.

Back home, it only took 15 minutes to replace the offending bushes and the BJ7 is now happy and surefooted back on the road.



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Thank you so much to club member David Francis for this month's photos. David's from North Nowra and is coming to the end of a long restoration of his 100.

It's probably long gone, but I recall driving south along the Princes Highway in years past. It was way before any attempt had been made to upgrade the road and at a sharp right hand turn of the road there was what looked to be a large cream or off white coloured building with the word 'AUSTIN' set into the façade. I sort of assumed that it had something to do with the vehicle manufacturer, but never did find out.

That's until just a few weeks back when I heard from David Francis who told me that his father Cec, was the local Austin agent in the Nowra area and that the building was part of the business.

David said that during the 1950s his father's agency sold five four-cylinder Austin-Healeys, one of which was a 100M. David was also very kind to send along some copies of photos taken during that period that might be of interest to club members.

The first photo is quite interesting as it clearly shows the back of an early BN1 and it was taken at Pymble on Sydney's north shore and from the note on the back it was 1953. The car looks to be heading north, probably not that far from the intersection of the Pacific Highway, Mona Vale Road and Ryde Road. The other cars look to be a Ford Consul and a Vanguard heading towards the camera. Having driven both a Consul and a Vanguard, the performance of an Austin-Healey 100 in comparison back in those days must have been phenomenal.

Photo number two again shows a 100, just near Pymble railway station. I don't know whether it's the same car or not, but it does say 1954 on the back and there is a story about the dog. Its name was Jerry and it went missing in Sydney. Despite exhaustive searches Jerry could not be found. All hope was soon lost, but a month or so later it was found that Jerry had walked from Sydney to the Francis Garage in Nowra. David described Jerry as a 'bag of





bones' and the local vet informed the Francis family that he would not survive and that it would be kind to carry out what was necessary. Cec Francis wouldn't hear anymore about it and took Jerry home and cared for him. Jerry went on to live for another 11 years.

The third photo is dated 1958 and shows David's wife Margaret in the 100M they had at the time.

Unfortunately David doesn't have the chassis numbers of any of the Austin-Healeys sold by Francis Garage in Nowra, nor are any of the company's records still available. Not to worry, as it was great that David went to the trouble of sending in the photos (hardcopy and by snail mail) for everyone to enjoy.

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It's been a busy month as far as rare or unusual Healeys and Austin-Healeys are concerned. Of greatest interest was the Bonhams Goodwood Revival Sale held at Goodwood on 15 September 2012 in conjunction with the hugely popular Goodwood Revival.

While there were such highly desirable cars as pre-war competition Alfa Romeos and Maseratis there were also ex Le Mans Lagonda V12 and Frazer Nash plus three cars of interest to us.

Firstly there was an early D-type Healey Silverstone, but with a difference. Back in the 1960s the standard four-cylinder Riley engine/gearbox/rear end gave way to a works Jaguar 3.8 straight six, gearbox and rear end. Throughout its life the Silverstone has been used extensively and successfully in competition and continues to be so until just prior to sale. It went for £88,860 (Aus \$138,357) including premium.

The next was a BN6 that started life as a works demonstrator and was featured in The Motor magazine as well as the film "School for Scoundrels". Not long after it was sold to well known Austin-Healey enthusiast Ted Worswick and with BMC assistance fitted with many parts from ex Works Rally Cars. Worswick then, with assistance from the BMC Competition Department went on to use the car very successfully in many period competition events throughout the 1960s. It is a well accepted car for well sort after European classic car events. It sold for £85,500 (Aus \$133,125) including premium.

The third car at Bonhams was probably the best and likely a very good buy at the price.



It was the 1964 Austrian Alpine Rally winning 3000 BJ8 driven by Paddy Hopkirk and Henry Liddon. The car went on to be run in the 1965 Targa Florio driven by Timo Mäkinen and Paul Hawkins and again in 1967 by Ted Worswick and Peter Clark. It was also raced in the 1967 BOAC '500' race. It is the only Works 3000 that was used internationally in both rallies and road racing. It sold for £242,300 (Aus \$377,267) including premium. Quite a few dollars! However whoever bought it got a lot of Works Austin-Healey for their money.

The fourth car of interest this month was auctioned half way around the world in Ontario, Canada and had its history dating back to the Paris Motor Show of 1947.

Of the 1,287 real Healeys built between 1946 and 1954 a total of 93 were sold in rolling chassis form to coachbuilders. It was at the 1947 Paris Motor Show that the Donald Healey Motor Company showed a rolling chassis to much acclaim. The result was a rush of orders from a number of European coachbuilders including Beutler of Switzerland that fitted the Healey chassis with attractive two-door coupe bodies.

How this car ended up in Canada in a provincial auction is a mystery. Most of the items up for sale fell into the automobilia area, except for the Healey and an American hot rod. With an estimate of between C\$25,000 and C\$45,000 there was no doubt



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many with their chequebooks waiting. However it eventually sold for C\$90,000 (Aus\$88,183) which was quite a steal. The story out there is that the Healey Beutler Coupe will receive a little TLC and soon it will be seen up for sale at a European auction house.



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BACK PAGE PICS

VISIT TO THE NEW SOUTH WALES RAIL TRANSPORT MUSEUM THIRLMERE

Photos by Anne Read



Jan Stirton, Anne Read and Pam Ross show a brave front waiting for the boys to stop playing with the trains.



Doug Ross, Jan Stirton and Don Read standing on Thomas' engine plate.



Carolyn Kent, Jan Stirton, Pam Ross, Doug Ross, John Kent, Neville Stirton and Don Read waiting patiently for a train.



Looking at how happy the lads are, they have just enjoyed playing with the trains.

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Austin Healey